

- *Server Side Java Bindings for Subversion* by Dave Brown
- *SVN Obliterate* by Julian Foad
- *Coding Control* by Perforce Software's Tony Smith

The message from Subversion developers to the users was to do some real testing of the pre-release versions (we don't want you to try on production data, though) of Subversion software to catch bugs early. The fact is it's difficult for developers to try and mimic the varied environments in which Subversion is deployed in organisations, and only the users can chip in here.

Users also expressed a requirement for pre-release binaries other than the source tarballs (which, currently, the Subversion Community is not engaged in providing). The developers took note of this and expressed a desire to work on some mechanism to get this done in the future. For what it's worth, in the recent past, the project has already started providing nightly tarballs of the latest trunk development sources (see reference [6]).

Another interesting take away from the conference was the community's feeling about Distributed Version Control Systems (DVCS). The community is excited about DVCS, since we are part of advancing the 'state of the art' and we are happy that, ultimately, we have competitors in the version control world. With the latest improvements on the WC-NG library, Subversion will be able to get features like offline commits, shelving, etc. I'd say that it's

premature to talk about this aspect now, but it is possible in the foreseeable future.

It was a nice experience for me to lurk around with the other developers at SubConf, with whom I've only communicated by e-mail till now. We also had a surprise in the week after the conference with the announcement made at ApacheCon 2009, about the Subversion project finding a new home at the Apache Software Foundation!

Subversion is a widely used version control system in many free software projects and corporate environments. The latest release of Subversion (1.6.6) source can be downloaded from <http://subversion.tigris.org>. If you want Subversion binaries for different platforms visit <http://open.collab.net>.  END

References

- <http://www.linuxforu.com/news/subconf-2009-a-report-day-1>
- <http://www.linuxforu.com/news/subconf-2009-a-report-day-2>
- <http://www.linuxforu.com/news/subconf-2009-a-report-day-3>
- <http://2009.subconf.de/vortraege/1-konferenztag>
- <http://2009.subconf.de/vortraege/2-konferenztag>
- <http://orac.ece.utexas.edu/pub/svn/nightly>
- <http://www.subconf.de>
- <http://www.collab.net>

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The author is currently employed by CollabNet, and is working for the Version Control group. He is a 'full committer' of the Subversion project and a free software enthusiast. To know more, visit www.stylesen.org.



▲ HOOD (conference organizers) stall



▲ CollabNet stall at SubConf 2009



▲ Perforce Stall at SubConf2009



▲ Subversion Hackathon Room at SubConf 2009